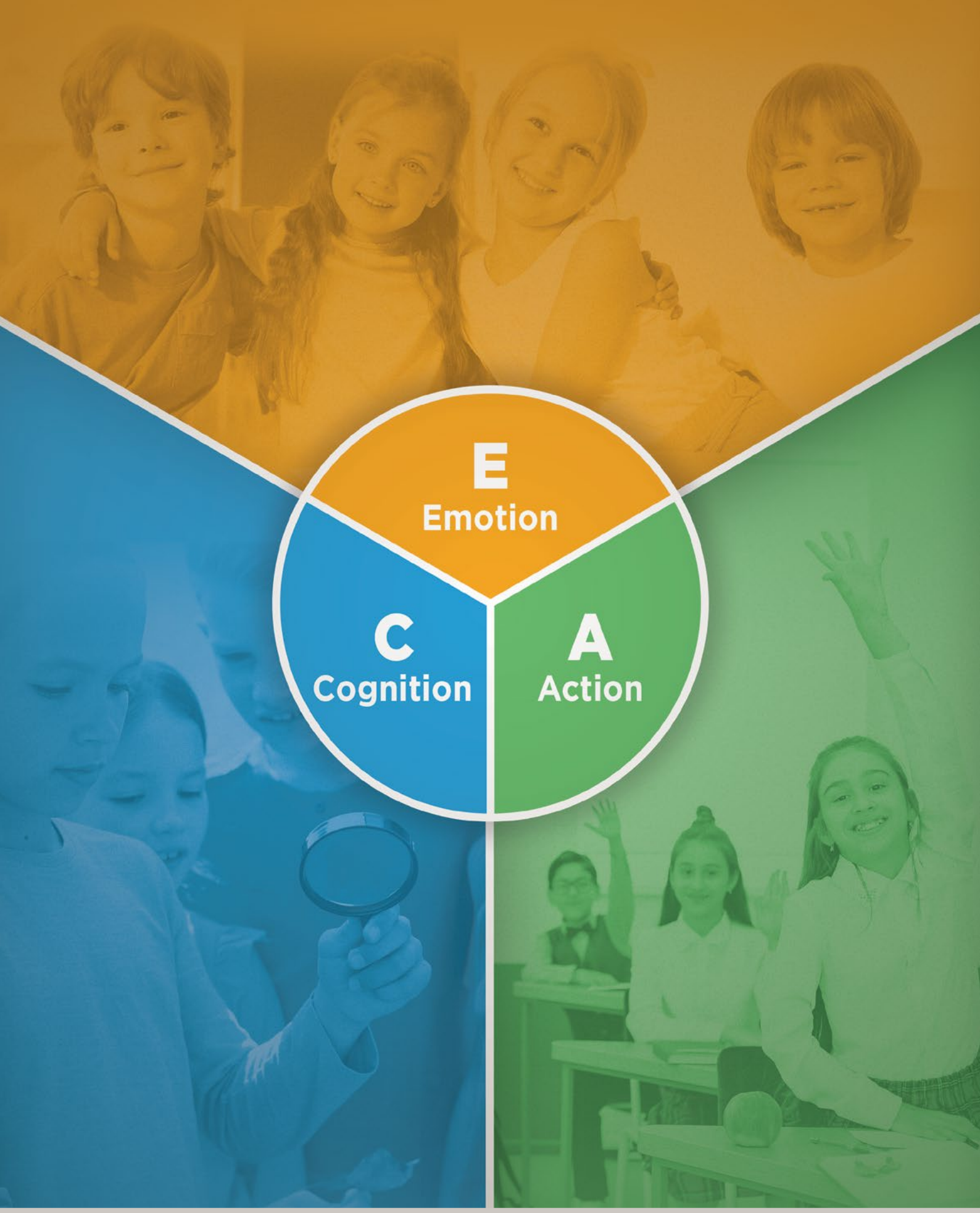




ECA Handbook



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Content

1. Introduction	4	Teacher's self-reflection	22
Aim of the project	4	Relationships at school	22
The logic of the Teacher's Handbook	5	Self-reflection mini – exercise	23
User Path Map	5	Security and autonomy	23
Traditional interactive or ECA class.	5	Annexes	25
Preparing for an ECA class	6	Annex I: How to relieve children's resistance?	25
Self-reflection mini-exercise	6	Annex II: Conflicts	26
2. The triple unity of ECA	7	Annex III: Evaluation of emotions	26
Introduction	7	Annex IV: Providing Choices	27
Basic steps in an ECA class.	7	Annex V: Action categories with examples	27
Emotion	8	Annex VI: Sustainability	28
Cognition	9	Annex VII: Creativity	28
Action	10	Annex VIII: Developing an ECA Lesson Plan Step-by-Step	30
Creativity	11	Annex IX: Introduction Guide	32
Developing an ECA lesson plan step by step	12	Annex X: Individual and differentiated learning management tips	33
Onboarding Guide	12	Annex XI: Sense of achievement	34
Self-reflection mini – exercise	13	Annex XII: Integrating self-study and group work	34
3. Individual and differentiated learning management	14	Annex XIII: Scaling	34
Student needs	14	Annex XIV: The self-assessment routine	35
Learner styles, multiple intelligences	14	Annex XV: Teacher Development Assessment	36
Love languages	15	Annex XVI: Assessment criteria	36
Assessing individual learning differences	15	Annex XVII: Receiving the student's self-assessment	36
Personality, connection, mentoring	16	Annex XVIII: Establishment of routines and subroutines	37
Sense of achievement	16	Annex XIX: Motivation	37
Integrating self-study and group work	16	Annex XX: Change Management	38
Individual Learning Agreement	16	Annex XXI: Teacher's Self-Reflection	38
Self-reflection mini – exercise	17	Annex XXII: Communication with parents	39
4. Monitoring and evaluation	18	6. Short lesson plans from practice	40
Documenting individual progress	18	Example 1: The Earth (LP1)	40
Evaluation – self-evaluation	18	Example 2: Volcanoes (LP 3)	41
Self-reflection mini – exercise	20	Example 3: The Human Body (LP 3)	41
5. The role of the teacher and competences	21		
Teacher attitude and skills	21		
Establishing routines and subroutines	21		
Motivation	21		
Change management	22		

1. Introduction

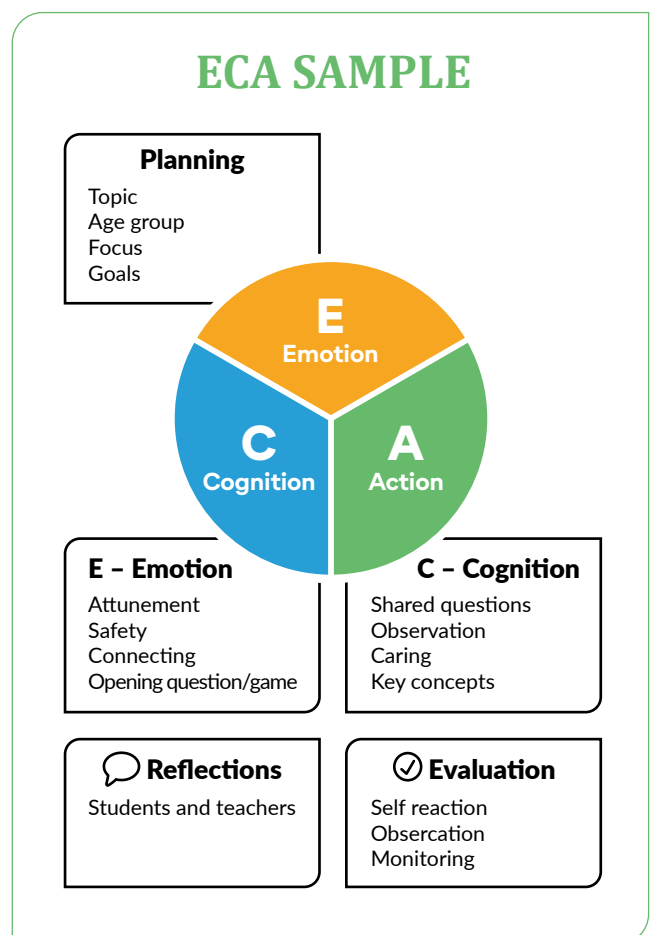
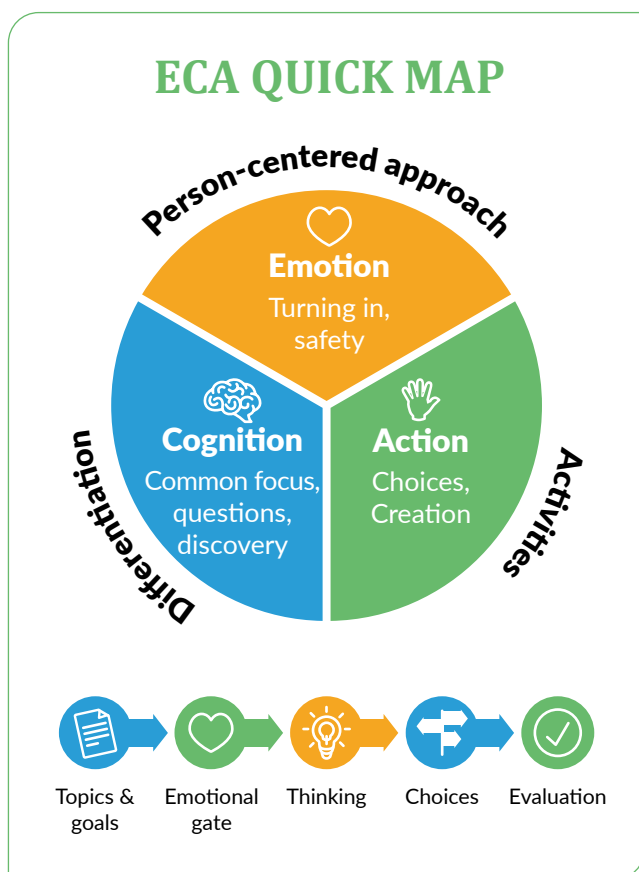
Aim of the project

The goal of the ECA (Emotion-Cognition-Action) project is the same as the ultimate goal of our Curriculum: to prepare teachers to be able to provide students with the greatest possible learning autonomy in the safest possible learning atmosphere.

Of course, you start getting acquainted with ECA at the theory, i.e. the Curriculum. The Handbook con-

tains practical tools for person-centred, ECA-based education in primary schools. As a teacher, you'll find games, templates, lesson plans, and checklists here. As you become familiar with these practical tools, you will also begin to acquire the attitude of person-centred pedagogy.

The **ECA QUICK MAP** is a quick visual compass for the entire ECA program, and the clock pattern is an easy-to-use template for everyday use.



The logic of the Teacher's Handbook

1. The triple unity of ECA: Basic ECA devices → here you can follow the blocks separately
2. Individual differentiation → personalization of ECA blocks (e.g. with a learning contract)
3. Monitoring → monitoring the effectiveness of the ECA
4. Teacher's role → fine-tuning of experience (with self-reflection)

User Path Map

- As a beginner teacher, start with templates and short game descriptions.
- As an experienced teacher, the first thing you should look for is differentiation tools and integration ideas.
- For lesson planning: ECA triple unity (pp. 6-13) → Choose an E/C/A tool for your theme.
- Group dynamics/emotion management: Emotion page (pages 8-9 and 26-27)

- For knowledge building: Cognition (pages 9-10 and 29-30)
- Activity planning: Action (pages 10 and 28)
- For individual differentiation: (pp. 13-18 and 36)
- For evaluation: (pages 18-21 and 39-40)
- For Your Own Development: (pages 21-24 and 42)

Traditional interactive or ECA class

As you progress through the Handbook, many things will become familiar. ECA is much more of a summary of teaching tools than a radically new methodology. Most of it is already used by teachers in their daily routine. Sometimes this, sometimes that. And here comes how ECA provides something new: by uniting the elements already used, it creates a new quality: the practice of person-centred pedagogy comes together. So, welcome what you're already doing as a familiar one, and consider introducing a new element.

Consideration	 Interactive traditional class	 ECA class
Motivation	Grade	Unique experience,
Assessment	Grading based on performance	Process-oriented self-assessment
Differentiation	Difficult to solve	Naturally comes
Action	Limited	Multiple, experiential, movements
Cognitive processing	Frontal, based on instructions	Self-contained, exploring, individual
Emotional involvement	Low-medium	High
Role of the learner	Student, receptive	Active, experimental
Focus	Transfer of knowledge	Experiences, complex development
Mode of operation	Instructions, problem solving	Unique products, complex

Preparing for an ECA class

Let's briefly review what it means to prepare for an ECA class for the teacher.

The first two steps do not contain anything new, this is how we usually do it.

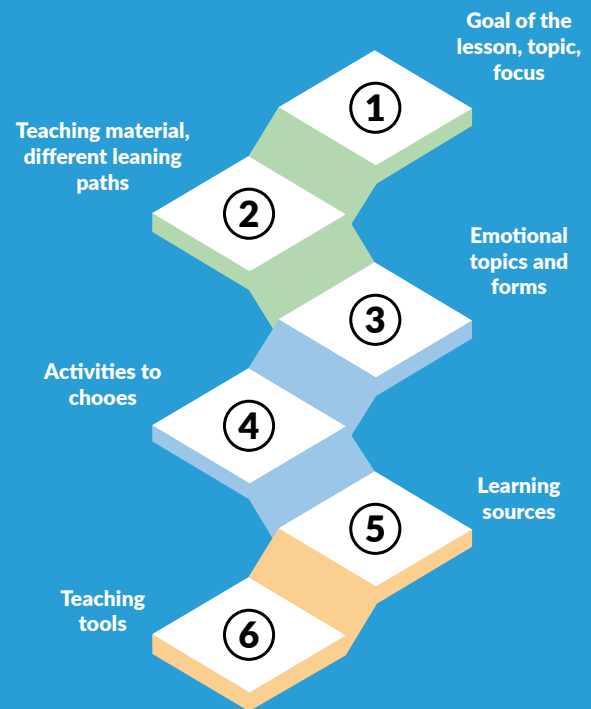
What is new in steps 3 and 4 is that we do not usually prepare with such a level of detail and so many optional tasks.

In the last two steps, thinking through the sources and taking into account multiple areas of intelligence can give a little work.

Self-reflection mini-exercise

- **Which thought grabbed you the most from all the previous ones?** Write it down and put it next to it: what does this mean to you in your own class?
- **How much do you feel like an „ECA teacher” on a scale of 1 to 10?** If you feel like moving forward, what is the first concrete step you would take?

ECA IN 90 MINUTES FOR SMALL KIDS



2.

The triple unity of ECA

Introduction

The ECA (Emotion – Cognition – Action) is the central toolkit of the Teacher's Handbook for primary school lessons. Roughly a third of a 90-minute period gives all three parts the right amount of time. The design routine of the traditional lesson can be used in each unit, supplemented by the content of ECA.

Here is an ECA planning template as a starting point.

- Theme
- Objectives
- Sources
- Emotional content
- Cognitive content
- Optional Activity List (Action)
- Prior knowledge (we have already learned, we need to know)
- Product
- Instructions
- Notes
- Self-assessment and feedback

Basic steps in an ECA class

Emotion

1. **Connection:** Short tuning moment - making eye contact, short game, etc.
2. **Emotional state reading:** A quick indication of how ready someone is to learn (card).
3. **Emotional framing:** A short support or a directing moment, if necessary.
4. **Step towards cognition:** Involving children, personal involvement, laying the groundwork for the topic.

Cognition

1. **Defining a common focus** – Short, clear goal and topic designation: one question, one problem

2. **Exploration** – Classwork. Students build understanding through their own perceptions.
3. **Joint settlement** – Discovery of key concepts, rules, conclusions.
4. **Short recording** – A short experiential summary, visual imprint.

Action

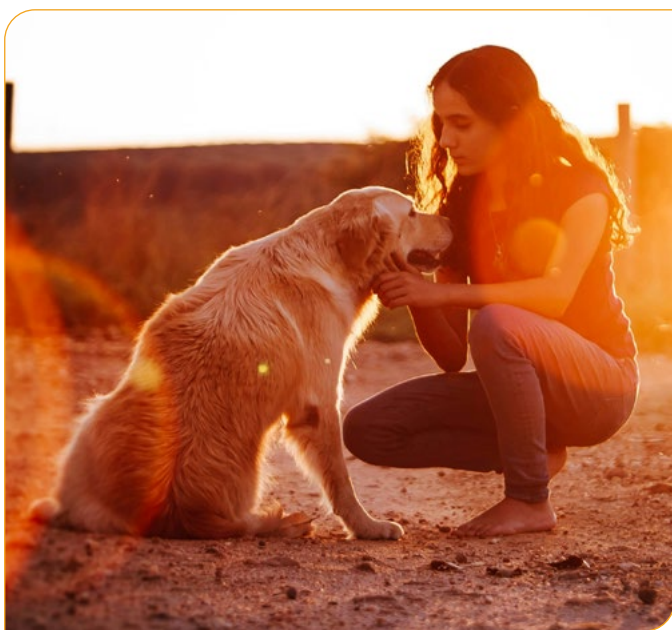
1. **Transition to action:** Inventing the activity. The goal is to deepen knowledge.
2. **Creating or practicing:** Completing the activity. The goal is to gain experience or practice.
3. **Share:** Brief introduction. The goal is to strengthen learning. Community response.
4. **Reflection:** „What happened inside me and what did I learn?“ The goal is to record the learning experience.

The ECA program helps to overcome the limitations of traditional, frontal teaching by focusing on children's emotional involvement, active participation, and learning based on their own experiences: own pace, motivation, connection to needs. We approach each child in a unique way, taking into account the characteristics of their age, so that those with learning difficulties can also find their place in the system. The following short video summarizes the experience of facilitation from the children: <https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=1693670721794962>

Possible difficulties with implementation – with answers:

- **Lack of time to fit into the curriculum** – We need to plan 90 minutes per session.
- **Student resistance** – We can rely on the group rules that we have agreed upon.
- **Lack of a supportive environment** – One teacher is enough. You just have to get going.
- **The need for independent tool and task development** – The school will be more experiential for the teacher as well.

- **Dealing with emotional challenges** – Preparation helps with this.
- **Difficulty in evaluation and feedback** – Process orientation needs to be prepared in a new way.
- **Technical or spatial limitations** – You can start in a simple classroom.
- **Maintain lasting motivation** – It's hard to switch from a daily routine, but it's worth it!
- **Fear of mistakes:** Be aware that mistakes are a natural part of functioning.



Emotion

The extent of emotional unity is deliberately greater, because this is where the most novelties arrive for teachers. This does not indicate a higher ratio between the three areas.

Emotion basics

The purpose of the E-block is to put children in an emotionally safe and connective state, because this is how their attention is opened, which helps them to retain information for a long time. The teacher's job is to create an accepting atmosphere, to create a connection that is in tune with each other, to help identify and organize emotions with simple tools and to lead them to the cognitive unit. Deeper, therapeutic exploration is not the teacher's task – see the theoretical background in the Curriculum.

A game that can help with this can be “Emotional Weather”. When entering, each child writes their name next to the weather icons on the board. This shows what mood they came with: sunny, cloudy, windy, stormy, rainbow. You can ask who wants to talk a little about their mood or what the stormy signal means, for example. Everyone just says what they want.

Emotional intelligence

Daniel Goleman gave this area a name and structure. In ECA, we strive to develop the following five core components.¹



Releasing resistance

There will always be those who are not in the mood for in-depth and essential reflective work right now or ever. There are many ways to solve this, and we give tips on this in → **Annex 1**. Here we will mention only one tool as an example: reminders. After discussing a topic, make a summary and display it in the room. In a moment of resistance, you can point to the poster, which recalls what you have learned about this topic.

- The key to distinguishing between betrayal and legitimate complaint is intention and weight: a

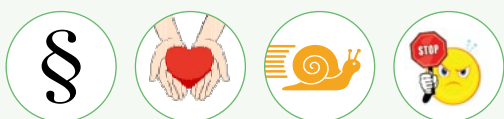
¹ <https://hu.wikipedia.org/wiki/Johari-ablak>

little stupidity, you have nothing to do with it vs. a serious injury that causes you harm.

- Of the reminders, giving and receiving criticism can look like this, for example. (Of course, it's much better if the kids come up with the pictograms.) The “decipherments” of the pictogram: it is in Annex 1.

HOW TO GIVE NEGATIVE FEEDBACK

Attitude



Be very concrete

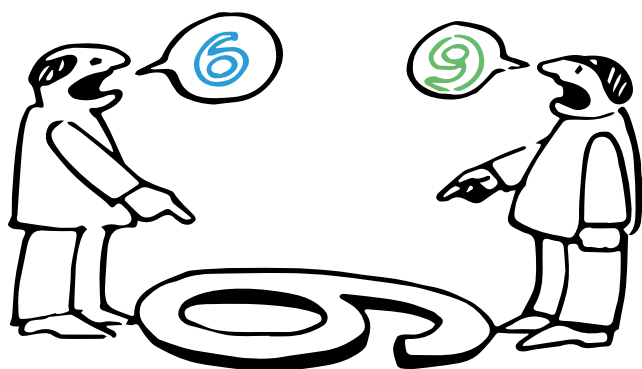


Content



“Interpretations” of the pictogram: →Annex 1

Conflict management



In a person-centred world, conflict is not a “distraction,” but a learning situation: we are taught that tension can be managed and that the relationship can be preserved. The teacher is present as a model: he does not look for the culprit, but helps both parties to say what they need. In →Annex 2, we summarize several small steps following the guidance of Rogers and Gordon.

Appreciation of emotions

When emotions and related skills are made part of the curriculum to such an extent, we also need to create the corresponding forms of assessment. In →Annex 3, we publish a possible list of these aspects.

The emotional stage creates security and helps children connect with their own feelings, the teacher and the group. This emotional foundation ensures that participation in the learning process is authentic and intrinsically motivated.

Pandora's Box

Many people fear that questioning emotions brings problems to the surface that go beyond the role or competence of the teacher. This is a real fear. In particularly difficult situations, it can easily happen that a child sees the teacher as an opportunity for help. Still, the question arises: is it really the solution to not talk about feelings? Perhaps we will not only avoid problems, but also the child himself. In our view, it is more important to pay attention sensitively, to understand what is hurting the child, and this is how we can look for appropriate solutions.



Cognition

The cognitive side of ECA is practically the material of a traditional lesson: knowledge transfer and skill development. The description of this unit is shorter, as this field is well known to teachers. ECA does not give you more or less cognition—so there is no need for a detailed introduction.

A teacher can confidently, quickly and professionally turn any topic brought up by him, the curriculum or a young student into an ECA curriculum. The steps are practically as follows:

1. **Cognitive topic, goals:** Choose a topic, list the key concepts you want to teach.
2. **Emotional involvement:** Look for a relevant situation (what is it about) / brainstorm together with the children.
3. **Offer promotions:** Activities or products - experiment, poster, presentation, etc.
4. **Develop the structure:** Time planning – prior knowledge – differentiation.
5. **Evaluation:** In a way that reflects on all three areas.

The most important criterion is to give yourself time to make the transition. Set yourself specific, measurable, realistic, SMART goals, with a relevant deadline!

The ECA approach activates and involves children: questions, feedback, sharing their own experiences. Use group discussions, joint problem-solving tasks, playful quizzes or digital interactive tools.

Textbooks, workbooks, wall maps, aids, graphic and visual tools on the one hand, and interactive whiteboards, tutorials, e-textbooks, multimedia educational packages, smartphones, tablets and laptops on the other. This duality characterizes our time. The solution is that awareness and combined use can make learning diverse.

What should we look at in textbooks when choosing a tool for “person-centred” teaching? Here are some ideas:

- Does it encourage action? (experiments, observations, projects)
- Do you have a teacher’s manual that helps differentiation?
- Are there reflective elements in it, questions of self-esteem?
- Are there any cooperative tasks in it?
- Does it help the children to start the tasks from their experiences and questions?
- Are the tasks presented in a small, short form (learning bits)?
- Is there an asynchronous curriculum available in blended form?
- Is blended learning supported by technology?

In general, we can say that the cognitive side is well thought out and elaborated in the framework curricula. The Cognition section supports understanding and the opening of ways of thinking, without pressure to perform. This way, children can develop their relationship to new knowledge at their own pace.



Action

Action is the action-based, experiential phase of the ECA process. This is where everything that has been moved in the emotional and cognitive preparation becomes visible: the child tries things out, experiments, creates, moves, interacts, shows himself. The goal of the action is not “good performance”, but experience – and experience, in which the child connects understanding with action at his own pace and in his own way.

The role of the teacher in this stage is to maintain a safe framework and a balance of freedom: he offers situations in which there may be multiple paths and solutions. The actions help children to bring emotions, thinking and activity together on an experiential level. In this way, learning can become a real experience that comes from within.

A number of actions are presented in →Annex 4, and then more organized into different categories in →Annex 5. The teacher can choose which one suits best the given moment based on his or her own group and the condition of the children. We have also included some tasks dealing with sustainability as a new topic (→Appendix 6). Here are two of the categories as examples:

- **Developmental games, problem-solving and communication tasks**
 - o How a small ball hits the ground the fastest so that everyone can touch it 1x and only one person can touch it at a time.

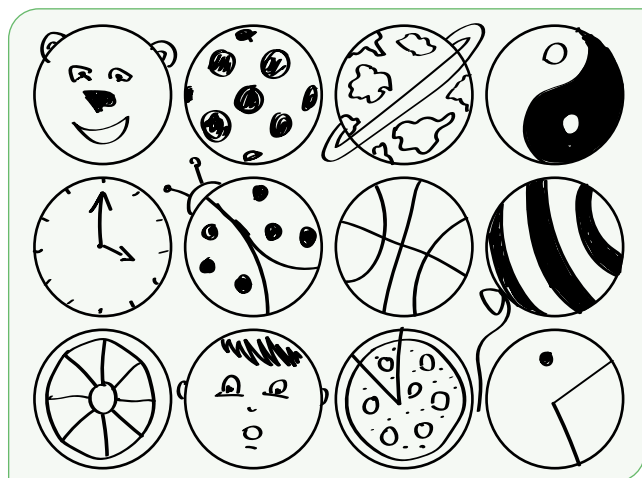
- o Arrange images in a story with your eyes closed as a group task.
- o How can we get rid of our original three tweezers on our clothes without getting new ones?
- **Artistic activities, object creation:** e.g. using natural materials
 - o Making puppets from natural materials found in the garden.
 - o A dance show about the performer's relationship with biology.
 - o Chemical elements when they meet: creative writing.

Creativity

Following Rogers' line of thought, creativity is given a prominent area in our curriculum. So let's look at it in more detail here, even though it's basically a spontaneous tool that applies to all three areas (and many more). However, its development can still go along with planned activities. We recommend several different steps, admitting in advance that children's spontaneous ideas always require careful consideration and are most often more important than plans. (→Annex 7)

As a teaser and to understand the concept of creativity, let's take the famous scene from the movie Apollo 13: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1cYzkyXp0jg>

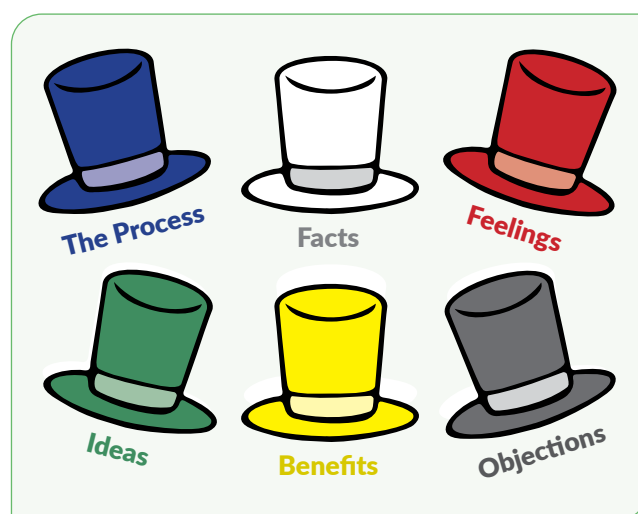
Torrance Test



Perhaps the most popular test measuring creativity is Ellis Paul Torrance's series of tests bearing his name. For example, one of the tasks in the series,

consisting of several exciting tasks, examines the areas of divergent thinking, such as fluence, flexibility, originality and elaboration. Thirty circles of the same size can be seen on one page. The task is to create as many images as possible in three minutes with using the circles. In addition to the fact that this is an interesting task, after the three minutes, we score what ideas are on the sheet according to the instructions developed to measure the above characteristics. Since creativity can be developed – this test can be a good starting point for comparison: how the wealth of ideas has changed, for example, in a year.

De Bono's Hat of Six Thinkers



It is a visual thinking framework that helps children think about a topic from different perspectives (facts, feelings, critiques, opportunities, ideas, summary). It can be used, for example, when adapting a fairy tale:

Hat	Feature	Question, aspect
White hat	Facts and figures	What can be seen in the picture?
Red hat	Feelings, intuition	How do you feel when you see the colours?
Black hat	Criticism, dangers	What is not good about this fairy tale?
Yellow hat	Positives, opportunities	What is beautiful about it?

Green hat	New approach, ideas	How to change it?
Blue Hat	Governance and summary	What is our plan?

So far, we have seen that creativity as a topic can also stand its ground in the ECA system as a separate skill development lesson. At the same time, we can connect it to subjects with the same validity. Here is a list with some ideas that are directly related to subjects:

- **Writing:** Rewriting fairy tales with their own endings or new characters.
- **Literature:** Tell the content of a fairy tale in six words without mentioning its title or main characters.
- **Visual:** Create a comic strip from simple stories.
- **Reading:** A role-playing game based on stories you read.
- **Counting:** Counting tasks with natural patterns. Find 5 square shapes in the garden.
- **Environmental education:** Making musical instruments from natural materials.
- **Tinkering:** Design and creation of simple tools from recycled materials.
- **Digital Culture:** Create interactive animations with simple digital programs.
- **Music:** Inventing melodies and rhythms using different natural materials.
- **Movement:** Free movement storytelling, dance and dramatization based on fairy tales.

Developing an ECA lesson plan step by step

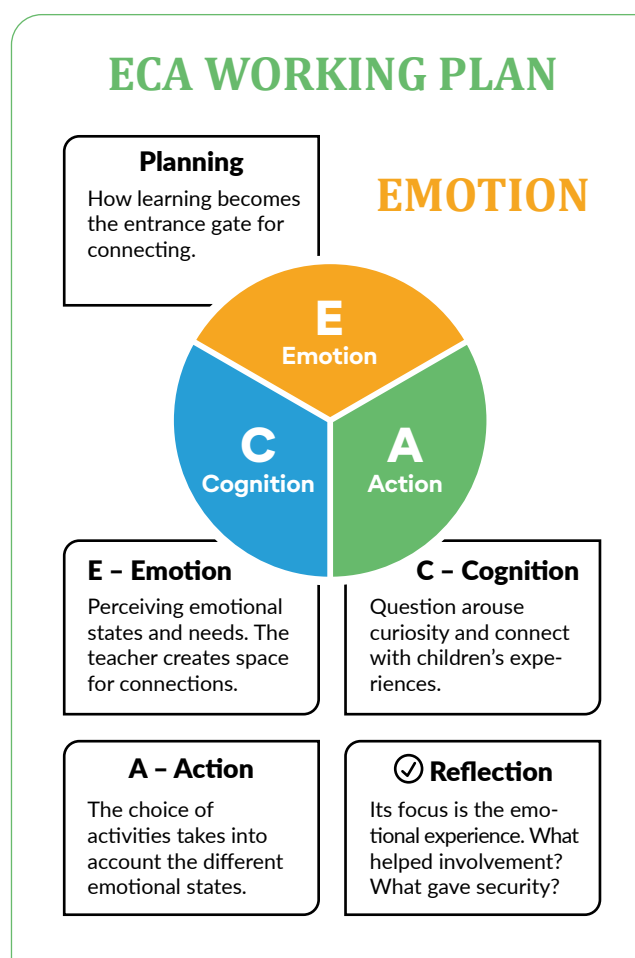
In the example library, there are several elaborate lesson plans on a wide variety of topics, and in the toolbox, we have placed a topic with an ECA approach that starts from the cognitive side and is built step by step. (→Annex 8)

If we add up the number of actions and practical applications a child can encounter in the example task above, we would get a pretty high number compared to the average lesson. Obviously, a small child can only choose to a limited extent, and

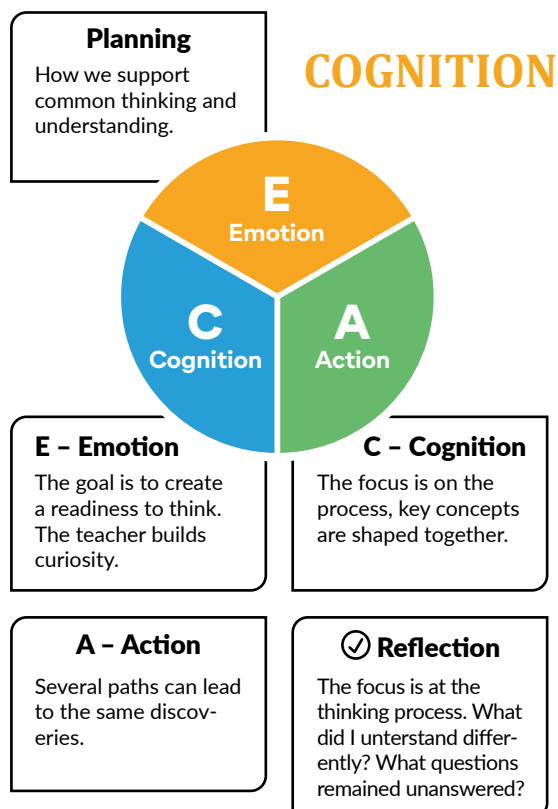
if they are even slower than average, we may be in the same place. But! In this class, each child worked according to their own choice, and this made it easier for them to want to solve the task in the best possible way. The best way to help a teacher's preparation is to know the children well, because then we can offer the tasks that are most likely relevant to everyone.

Onboarding Guide

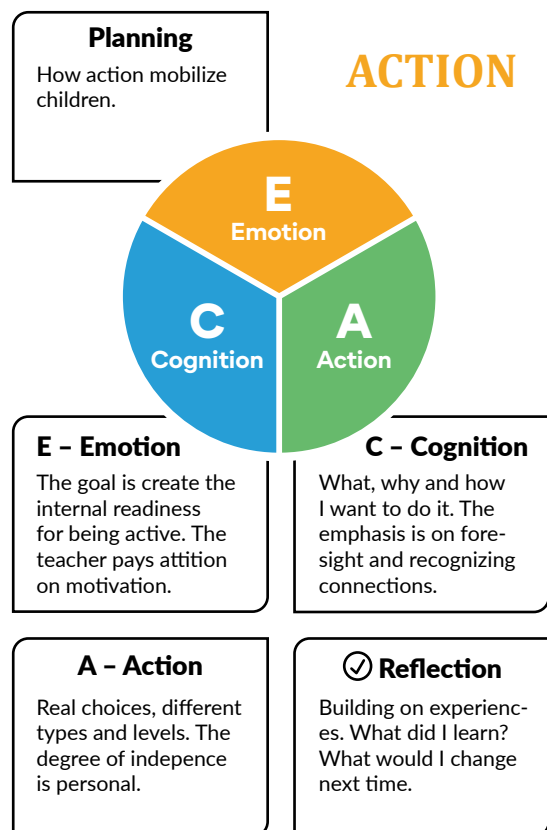
Going from teacher to facilitator is a long process. The ECA approach requires a long period of preparation. This is a fact. In →Annex 9 there is a summary of how a teacher can comfortably switch to this system in, say, a year. Approximately every two months, a new focus can be built into the existing ones. Of course, if this seems too fast with the many teaching tasks, it is possible to plan a more in-depth knowledge and testing of the elements of the system for two years.



ECA WORKING PLAN



ECA WORKING PLAN



Self-reflection mini - exercise

- Think back to a class where the triad of Emotion, Cognition, and Action has already appeared "accidentally": what happened at the beginning, in the middle and at the end, which can be linked to them.
- Choose an upcoming topic and formulate it in 3 sentences: what emotional state, what kind of thought process and what action do you want to see.

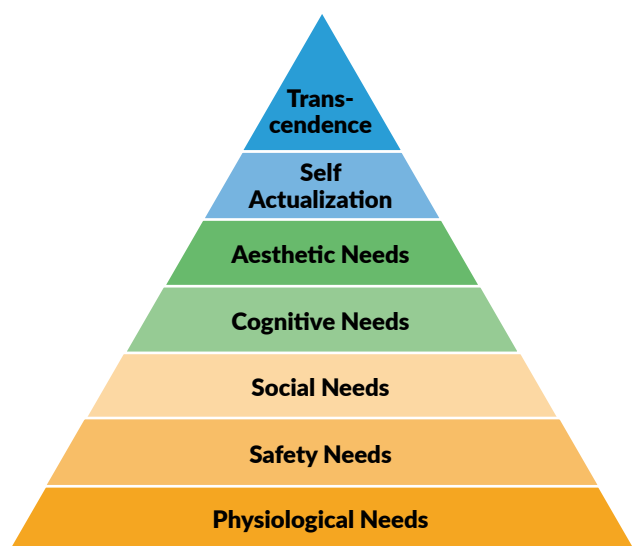
3.

Individual and differentiated learning management

We have reached one of the cardinal points of what we have to say. One of the – FEASIBLE! – focuses of person-centred pedagogy is how to create the appropriate, motivating and developing learning environment for all students in a group. We are different – accepting this is one of the important insights that fundamentally determines the teacher's attitude.

Student needs

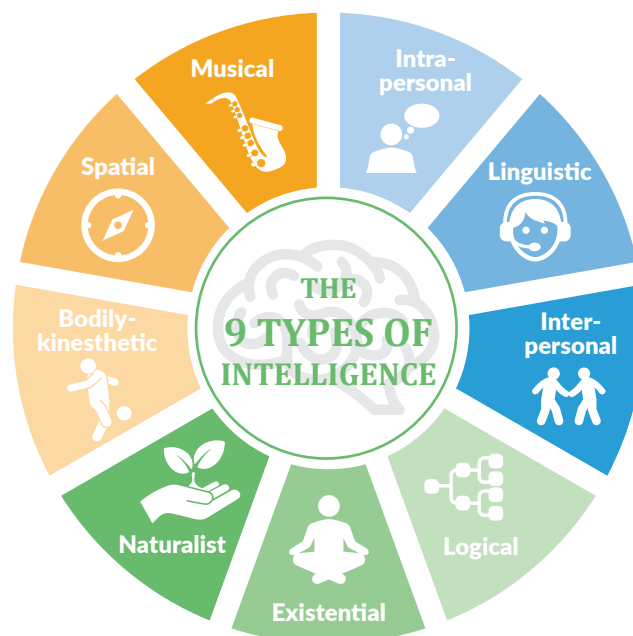
Maslow's pyramid reminds us that higher-level learning goals can only be achieved when a person's basic physical, safety, and relational needs have already been adequately met. As teachers, we always look at on what level there is an urgent need to do something right now – rest, safety, acceptance or challenge. Let's look at a game to answer this question:



Learning gas station: There are 4 “fountains” (with inscriptions or pictograms) on the board: 1. “eating/drinking/resting”, 2. “safety”, 3. “friends”, 4. “challenge”. The children indicate with a sticker where they feel “empty” right now (max. 2 places). In a short class-level meeting, we think about what we can do today to make learning feel good.

Learner styles, multiple intelligences

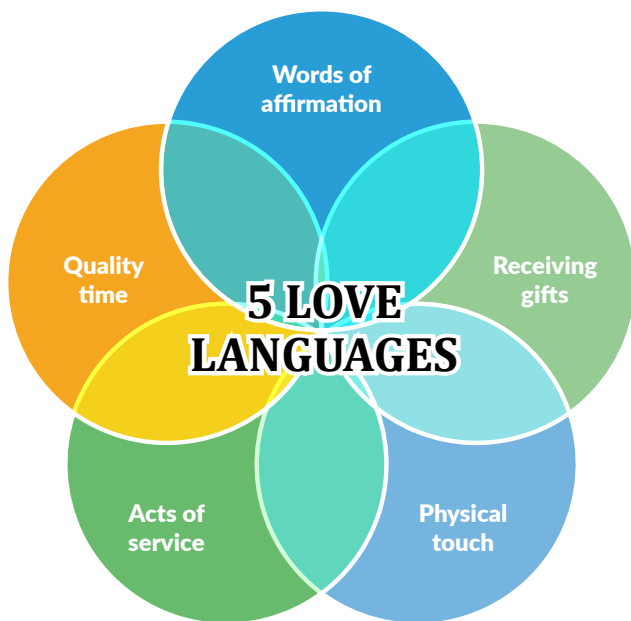
Howard Gardner's theory builds on the different strengths of children (e.g. language, logic, physical movement, musical, social, etc.) and sends a message to the teacher that he or she can have the same topic processed by different activities based on multiple intelligences. The examples in →Annex 10 will help you understand how to involve different areas of learners' intelligence in education at the same time. The point is to offer at least 2-3 separate channels in an ECA unit so that as many children as possible can find a „gate” to the topic. Let's look at a relevant game!



“Intelligence Gates”: We process the same tale through several types of intelligence. After reading a short story together, the children write / act out a new ending / invent a rhythm for each character, with which they speak and move, make a comic, etc. The reflective question at the end of the class could be: How did you choose?

Love languages

Knowledge of love languages helps the teacher to recognize that children experience attention, acceptance and recognition in different ways. Some people are motivated by an encouraging sentence, others need time together, touch, small gestures or help. If the teacher finds the form of connection that means the most to the given child, it is easier for them to develop a safe and trusting relationship. This increases the child's self-confidence, cooperation and willingness to learn.²



Assessing individual learning differences

In order to help a student's development, we need to know them. We have many answers to the question of „how”:

- Observations in classes using observation sheets
- Diagnostic questionnaires about difficulties and strengths
- Conversations with open-ended questions
- Knowledge of MBTI
- Knowledge of the intelligence types
- Maslow's pyramid based on questions
- Through consultation with parents
- From conversations with other teachers

During the preparation for the ECA lesson, the teacher collects and analyses preliminary information, and plans differentiated tasks in advance. Practical steps:

1. preliminary monitoring and data collection,
2. involving students with self-reflection exercises,
3. planning differentiated tasks by rethinking the areas of multiple intelligence,
4. consideration of individual and group support strategies,
5. maintaining communication with families and professionals.

When planning tasks, we don't have to be too different from the usual: we simply take the next topic. We work out what we want to teach in the traditional way. After defining the topic – i.e. during the preparation – we record what emotional and social issues we want to connect the given topic with. We are looking for answers to the following questions:

- What is the group focusing on right now?
- What are the relations like between each other?
- What can I do most for peace or to keep the peace?
- What issues would be good to talk about?
- What has happened recently that we can use to improve the group atmosphere?
- Is there any conflict in the air?
- Is there a conflict between anyone?
- Who is not feeling good these days, why and what can we do about it?

These questions are already on the mind of teachers, but here and now we also create the space to unfold these questions. It is also true here that in class, the children will help by expressing their current feelings. The rest is already decided there.

These questions are already on the mind of teachers, but here and now we also create the space to unfold these questions. It is also true here that in class, the children will help by expressing their current feelings. The rest is already decided there.

² Source of the figure: <https://www.napfenyesgyogykozpont.hu/az-ot-szeretetyelv-1-resz/>

Personality, connection, mentoring

We have also collected some aspects based on which the teacher can prepare to develop a more personal relationship with the students and to play an effective mentoring role.

- Take the time to really listen to the child, noticing the nonverbal cues as well.
- Talk regularly with children individually about personal topics and feelings.
- Consciously seek out and strengthen the individual strengths of the children.
- Observe the rules of trust and confidentiality.
- Work out individual goals with each child, look for and monitor changes together.
- Be consistent, authentic, set an example.
- Encourage experimentation and independence.
- Accept unique situations.
- Organize joint programs.
- Provide regular, constructive feedback.
- Active listening and empathy, supportive responses, being non-judgmental – these are all important.
- Accurate self-expression, honesty, flexibility, adaptability – we practice them.

Sense of achievement

There are so many different ways to get a sense of accomplishment! In a class of 20 children, there are certainly some children who find joy in writing, but even they probably approach success in different ways: one finds it in writing, the other in formulating creative thoughts. We have collected some aspects that can be used to ensure motivation and the quality of learning. (→Annex 11)

Integrating self-study and group work

The task set out in the title is one of the keys to the practical implementation of the person-centred approach. There are many aspects to consider when building your strategy. See →Annex 12.

ECA requires longer and more complex preparation as it is tailored to the needs of the students. To achieve this, it is essential to develop a range of teaching skills and attitudes. Some of them have already been discussed in detail. More tips can be found in the attachment above.

If a teacher finds pleasure in differentiation and the individual development of the students, and it is a high level of motivation for him, every hour spent in the classroom will be enjoyable and he can expect real, deep experiences and connections.

Individual Learning Agreement

Carl Rogers suggests the following steps for the process of developing and monitoring personalized development plans:

- **Starting point assessment:** Mapping the students' current skills, knowledge, strengths and areas for improvement with various diagnostic tools (tests, observations, conversations).
- **Setting individual development goals together with the given child:** Setting realistic, measurable, motivating goals together with the active participation of the student (and with parents and professionals if necessary), which take into account the student's needs and interests.
- **Developing a flexible development plan together with the student:** Planning learning activities and methods to support the achievement of individual goals, providing resources.
- **Implementation and support:** continuous support of the student, mentoring support, giving feedback during the learning process. Providing regular self-reflection sessions.
- **Communication and cooperation:** continuous contact with the student (if necessary, with parents and other stakeholders) to support development.
- **Monitoring and evaluation:** documentation (logs, portfolios, continuous measurement), comparison of results with the originally set goals, and modification of plans as necessary.

Let's see the aspects for such a contract!

Contracting parties:

Goal of the contract:

Content of the contract:

Object of the contract:

Working method:

Time of working:

Place of working:

Necessary tools, person to provide them:

Quality criteria:

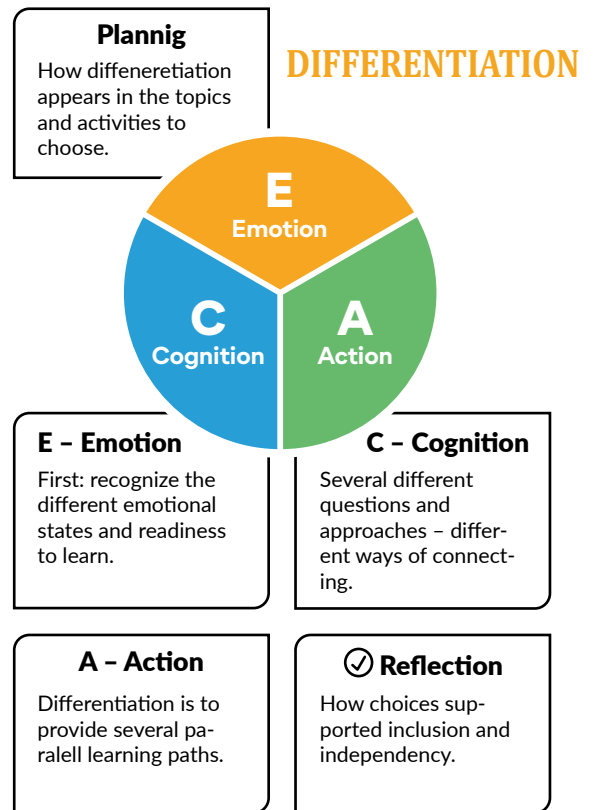
Date, signatures

Subsequent additions and changes.

Of course, any changes from now on can only be born from the discussion between the two parties.

Finally, the usual lesson pattern.

ECA WORKING PLAN



Self-reflection mini – exercise

- Imagine your current class and write the initials of three students who are very different in terms of learning. In one word for each, name what distinguishes them.
- **Decide:** for which of them you will make a small, personalized modification in the next week (different device, different amount of tasks, different type of task tailored to them).

4.

Monitoring and evaluation

Documenting individual progress

Progress chart

This is a visual tool: we display in a large table on the wall who has undertaken what and who is working on what. When a part of the unit is complete, the student can colour that cell. Its simplicity makes it easy to apply and to follow a weekly or monthly plan. If we notice that someone works slower due to their abilities, the difference can be shown visually.

Individual monitoring, small group meeting

The teacher can follow up on the work by organizing individual or small group discussions. Verbal feedback provides quick information about progress, while teacher observation notes provide a detailed picture of students' progress in larger units.

Feedback

There is a theory, the Johari window,³ in which there is a special place when others who know something about us share this knowledge or opinion. This expands the „open“ area, that is, the part that we and others know about us. There are many ways to get feedback, and it's hard to list how many ways we can get an idea of how others see us. For example:

1. Oral information from teachers or peers
2. Written: analysis, project evaluation
3. Digital feedback systems, applications, interactive interfaces
4. Observations
5. Discussions, joint analysis
6. Video recordings
7. Questionnaires about student satisfaction, motivation and difficulties
8. Formal assessments, tests, exams (for grading or diagnostic purposes)

9. 360-degree evaluation: all participants in the process provide feedback.

10. Scaling

The more ways we give feedback, the better! By the way, this also applies to evaluation.

Evaluation – self-evaluation

In the ECA system, all our teaching efforts support the development of personality and creativity. This includes evaluation. According to Carl Rogers, education is as person-centred as the focus is on self-assessment in evaluation. While self-assessment is not necessarily part of a traditional lesson, the most important aspect of assessing an ECA class is how the individual, the given student, sees their own progress. Specific solutions can be:

Self-Assessment:

- **Scaling:** The student can evaluate their own performance and progress on well-understood scales. (The teacher can also fill it in). In fact, the really person-centred solution will be for the children to write the scale for themselves.
- **Portfolio:** An ever-expanding collection of documents that presents the learning process, outcomes, and progress. This is the basis of self-assessment and teacher feedback, and it is also an information for parents. Can also be stored digitally (e.g. Google Classroom).
- **Self-Assessment Templates:** For all three aspects of ECA. We must be careful that neither the questions nor the answers are stereotypical. It helps if we use different forms in addition to verbatim (visual, moving, etc.).

³ <https://hu.wikipedia.org/wiki/Johari-ablak>

In →Annex 13, we give three specific examples of scaling: an emotional, a cognitive, and an activity scale.

Building a self-assessment routine

It happens with many young children that they do not feel like doing the self-assessment or do not take it seriously and so it becomes stereotypical. Building a self-assessment routine takes a lot of time and patience. Its steps are summarized in →Annex 14.

Teacher Development Assessment

There are many forms of developmental evaluation.

- Oral
- Written
- Creative shapes
- The grade: By explicitly naming as many aspects as possible, it can be made up of many small grades: achievement of requirements, knowledge, skills, class work, behaviour during task solving, diligence, etc.

In →Annex 15, we have summarized all the things that can affect the effectiveness of teacher assessment.

Definition of the evaluation criteria

It is best if the assessment criteria are drawn up together with the student and the teacher. The student knows what he wants to assess, the teacher knows what needs to be assessed on the basis of the National Curriculum. So if the aspects are worked out together, the student will think through the requirements precisely, and the teacher will be able to help the student's work more accurately. Of course, everything has to happen before work. We have summarised what we should think about when formulating these criteria in →Annex 16.

The Deal

Their teacher chooses how much they make the children's self-assessment a part of the grades at

the end of the semester or the end of the year. It is already a great thing to embed self-reflection and self-assessment in the learning process itself. However, how much more valuable it is if the little child experiences that what he thinks about his own performance shapes his grade in the certificate! The bargain between the teacher and the student about the incorporation of self-assessment into the formation of the final grade can be realized on several levels:

1. The teacher listens to the students, reacts to him/her, but doesn't take it into account when giving the grade
2. The teacher listens to the student and takes it into account when giving the grade
3. Grade through common agreement: common assessment through a discussion

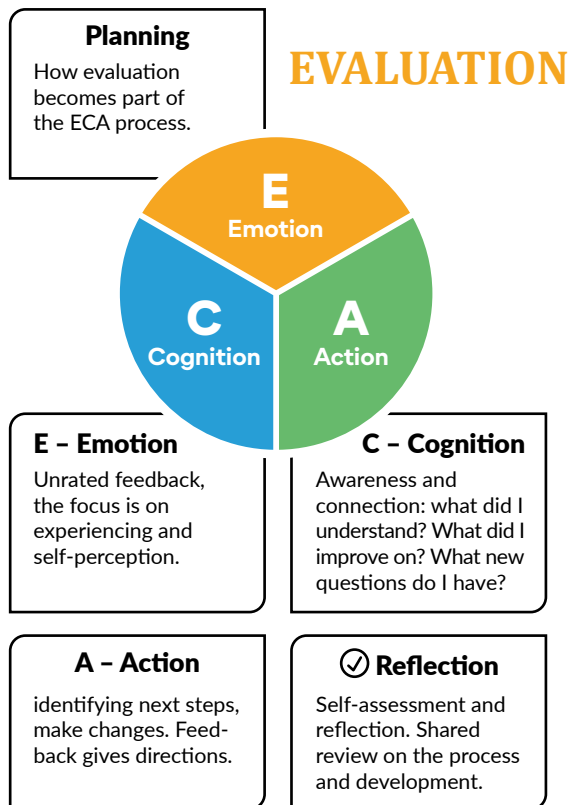
On what basis should we accept the student's self-assessment?

Practical experience shows that most students tend to be stricter with themselves than their teachers. There are a few aspects that can help the teacher to turn the Deal into a grade (→Annex 17). Fortunately, there is already a departure at the official level from the evaluation defined only in grades. Today, in many places, a child is evaluated in developmental essays in primary school.

It is important to see that the steps of person-centred education are interconnected. This is a system:

1. Assessment of individual needs (styles, needs)
2. Learning contract + individual/group mix
3. Measurement, monitoring, Progress chart (with E/C/A columns),
4. Individual monitoring + Small Group Reflection
5. Fine-tuning (with checklists)

ECA WORKING PLAN



Self-reflection mini – exercise

- Think about how often you ask the children, “How do you rate your work today?” – write down your honest estimate (never, sometimes, often).
- Write down two simple self-assessment questions that you will try at the end of class the following week, e.g. “What went well today?”, “What would you do a little differently next time?”.

5.

The role of the teacher and competences

The last chapter is devoted to the formulation of perhaps the most important condition. It focuses on the pedagogical role that makes all elements of the ECA approach alive through the personality of the teacher. In the Introduction we justified the need for this approach, then we got to know ECA, broken down into its parts. Differentiation, assessment and learning management decisions all work through the teacher's personal presence, sensitivity and professional responsibility. For example, the formative approach presented in the chapter on assessment does not appear in practice as a separate toolkit, but as part of the continuous work of teachers. As we have seen in the chapter on differentiation, ECA does not work in separate task packages, but as a series of decision points. In this part, we consider that the teacher is not only the user of the framework, but also its most important carrier. This chapter is about his inner work.

Teacher attitude and skills

Rogersian communication emphasizes „good listening”, active listening, and the accurate understanding and reflection of the child's feelings. The „Facilitator Mirror” exercise can be linked to this, which serves to raise awareness of the teacher's own role. After an ECA class, we answer 3 quick questions in our diary: „When did I ask rather than explain?” „When did I allow someone to choose?” „When did I notice and react to a child's signal?” It helps a lot if we make a video during a lesson or write a detailed note about it (if we have the strength to do so!)

Establishing routines and subroutines

Routines are there to make our lives easier, to be able to pay attention to important, changing tasks and circumstances. At the same time, routines also limit us, and habit limits creativity. Specifically, what

routines can help a teacher to implement ECA? It cannot be said that the list is exhaustive, but it is good to think about the ones listed in →Annex 18.



Motivation

Every chapter and thought in the Teacher's Manual is based on the idea that natural learning conditions are motivational. We have prepared it so that every teacher can implement what they can use authentically from the ones listed here. Our checklist contains many items (→Annex 19). The topic of motivation also includes what the teacher does with students who find it difficult to tolerate sudden changes. We have also looked for some tips for this common problem (→Annex 20).

Change management

Knowing the Curve of change can be another tool in the hands of the teacher.



Knowing the curve, the teacher is able to interpret the children's reactions more realistically when introducing a new situation, rule or form of learning. The figure associated with the name of Elisabeth Kübler-Ross points out that change can often trigger uncertainty, resistance or even setbacks before adaptation and acceptance appear. If the teacher recognizes which stage a child or group is currently in, he or she will be less likely to see difficulties as a personal failure and will be able to support the process with more patience. This helps to ensure that change appears as a natural path of development, each stage of which is an important part of learning and adaptation.

Teacher's self-reflection

If we consider self-reflection important in a small child, we must be able to do it ourselves. Some aspects based on experience can help you think about the question (→ [Annex 21](#)).

Studying the above appendix, you may notice that this list of teachers' self-reflection is little different from what we have been thinking about so far: the emotional and social development of young children. This is no coincidence. We may know more on the cognitive side, but in the emotional field, we always have the same amount of material in front of us as in front of the little ones – just on a different level.

Relationships at school

Parents

Setting boundaries is key: a clear framework is needed that protects the child's personality and secrets, while leaving room for the constructive participation of parents. This is helped by regular, transparent information about class life, student development and teaching principles, as well as by gradually tuning parents into non-violent communication – by setting an example, common rules, open questions and consciously taking the time. Again, we have collected some aspects of this topic (→ [Annex 22](#)).

The final lesson of this chapter is twofold. Don't ask children to do something and don't put them in a situation that you don't want to take on yourself. The reverse is also true: we should be as open as children who are put in a position by a benevolent and competent teacher (ourselves) for their own development. Let's be our own teacher and learn from the children.

Colleagues

ECA can be introduced in only one lower grade, but teaching teams can also be established. If you work in a team, it is important to pay attention to a few basic things. The teaching team can work well along the same values and common goals.

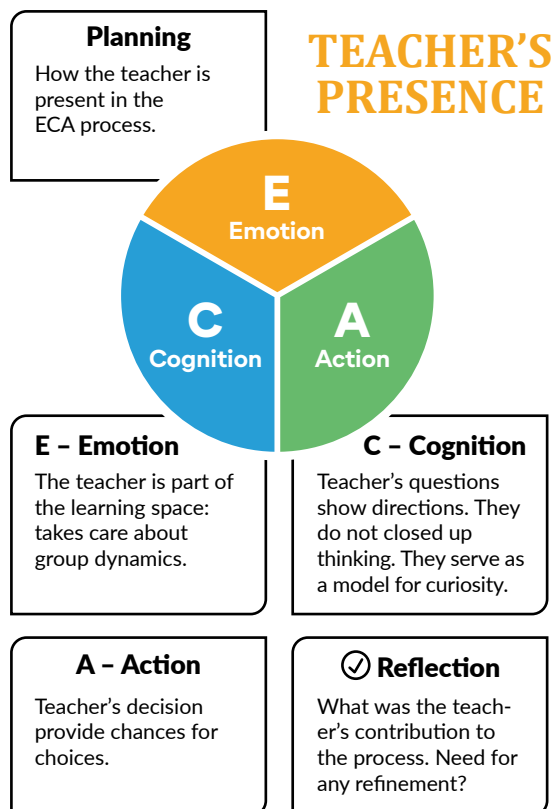
So far, we have rather strived to show the wide range of possibilities of classroom-level solutions. Teachers have an interesting job ahead of them if they want to develop a school-level cycle of ECA for one school year, or if they want to get resistant colleagues or school management on their side.

School management

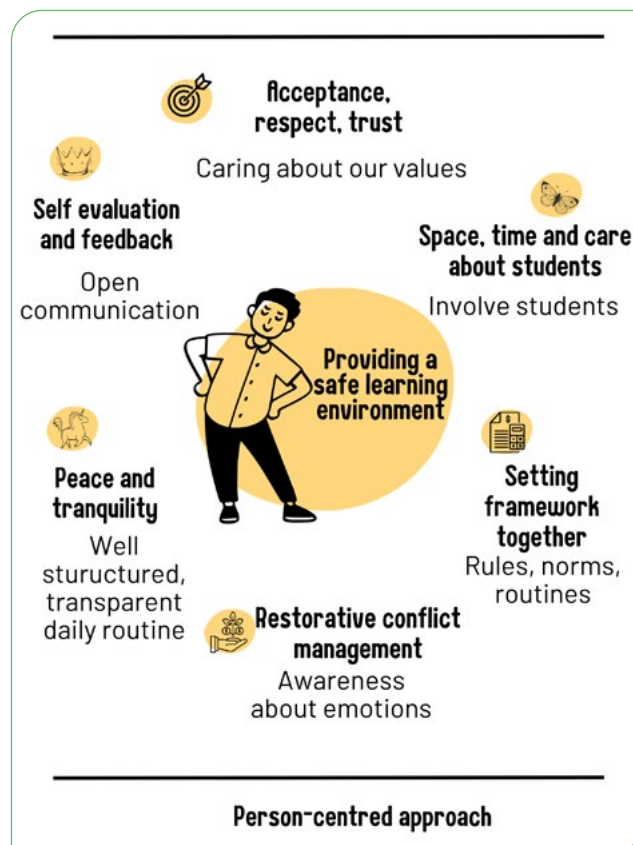
The ECA program can appear not only in the lessons of an enthusiastic teacher, but can also be integrated into the operation of the entire school. In such cases, for example, a conscious connection to the assessment of competences is crucial, because this is how the added value of ECA becomes visible to the school management and the maintainer.

Here is the usual ECA lesson pattern related to the topic.

ECA WORKING PLAN



the Big Picture: we try to shape the teacher's attitude with systems, techniques and methods that keep the above goals in focus. These two goals can be created in any – even traditional – school, as we have seen, it is possible to start towards them in small steps.



Self-reflection mini – exercise

Self-reflection here is not an independent technique, but arises from its approach:

- Choose one of the teaching roles (e.g. facilitator, mentor, team player) and mark on a scale of 1 to 10 how comfortable you feel in it now.
- Write down in one sentence in what small situation you will consciously practice this role in the next week (e.g. "in this group work, I only ask questions, I don't give a solution").

Security and autonomy

At the beginning of this manual, we named these two concepts as the goals of the project, the curriculum and the manual. So here is a list at the end that shows





The ECA approach cannot be separated from the person of the teacher. Methodological elements alone do not guarantee person-centred operation: the creation of safety, the quality of the connection with the children, the timing of decisions and reflective presence are the factors that fill the framework with content. This chapter gives responsibility: the professional and human task of the teacher to accompany the children's learning journey flexibly and authentically by continuously examining their own functioning. Ultimately, ECA is not an applied model, but a lived pedagogical practice. Differentiation is not a technique, but an approach, evaluation is not closure, but an act of learning. These make this wonderful work, teaching enjoyable, useful, and humanly sustainable.

ECA can also be understood as a pedagogical building, based on shared values. On this foundation the supporting elements of emotions, cognition and activities are built: a multitude of attitudes, skills, methodological decisions, of which the list is not and cannot be exhaustive. Evaluation and self-reflection are the binders that organize all this into a unit, because it is present at all levels and constantly shapes the whole structure. In this metaphor, the teacher is the architect: the one who responsibly shapes the relationship of the elements to each other at the level of actions, in order to create a safe, intimate and creative space for children. In such a space, motivation is not an external tool, but a natural consequence of learning (autonomy, competence, security) – both for the children and for the teacher.

Annexes

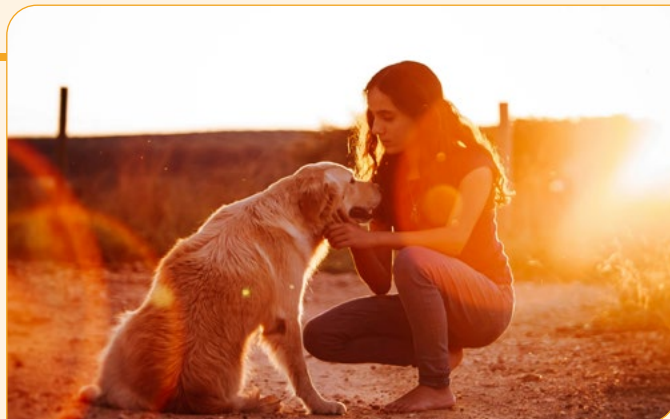
Annex 1

How to relieve children's resistance?

It happens in ECA classes that some children occasionally or permanently resist new situations, reflective conversations, or unusual tasks. The goal is not to „break” this resistance, but to help them with curiosity, giving them security: they should have a choice, they should be given time, and they should experience that their pace, feelings, and even reluctance are okay in the group.

- Let's share some communication blunders. Eg.: <https://www.facebook.com/watch?v=539053321261977>
- Let's collect "social" scenes from movies.
- We look for jokes. What can we learn from this joke? 50th wedding anniversary: The woman prepares breakfast that day and says to herself, "I'm going to eat the top of the bun today. I've been making buns for 50 years, and always the bottom is left for me, I've always given the top to the old man. Today it will be different for once." She brings the buns. The old man says: "How did you know that I have been longing for the bottom of the bun for fifty years?"
- Let's play empathy-developmental exercises with movement: Children imitate the movements and sounds of different animals while feeling the "emotions" and behaviour of that animal.
- Empathy is not enough, it is also necessary for this understanding and empathy to reach the other party. One activity to help with this: Inventing picture stories: Based on a picture book, children can guess how the characters feel. The pictures can also be drawn by the children beforehand. With this, they practice how they can express these feelings.

Deciphering the pictogram of "giving negative criticism":



Attitude:

1. You have the right to criticize.
2. Say everything with love.
3. Finish as fast as possible!
4. Criticize the behaviour not the person!

Be specific:

1. Talk to them in person, not by email.
2. Make a request!
3. It's best when and where the problem arises.

Content:

1. Say one thing at a time!
2. Ask him how he sees it.
3. Summarize what you have agreed on.

HOW TO GIVE NEGATIVE FEEDBACK

Attitude



Be very concrete



Content



Annex 2

Conflicts

Thomas Gordon took many small steps, and others were taken by person-centred pedagogy to deal with incipient conflicts. Here are some of them:

Specific mediation steps

1. **I stop the situation:** "Now let's stop for a moment, what happened here is important."
2. **Hearing both parties separately:** "Tell me what you think happened"
3. **Name feelings:** "How did it feel for you? Were you embarrassed...?"
4. **Formulating a need, a request:** "What do you want to happen now? What do you ask from your partner?"
5. **Looking for a common solution:** "What would be a solution that is good for both of you?"
6. **Agreement and closure:** "You have agreed that... What will you try next?"

Sentence patterns for children

- "When ... I felt: ..."
- "I wish you were ... the next time"
- "I'm sorry that ..., next time I'll try to ..."
- "Now I need ..."

Short Games

- **The "I understand you exactly" pen:** anyone can only speak when they have the Pen. And it can be possessed if someone interprets what his partner has to say accurately and in a way that is confirmed by the other party.
- **"Animal roles in conflict":** You choose 3-4 animals and conflict management methods (e.g. turtle – hides, lion – attacks, owl – talks, fox – tricks). The children play out how each person solves an argument in small stories, and then you discuss: "Which animal's solution really helped? In what?"
- **"Emotion-Solution Cards":** Two sets of cards: emotions (angry, sad, disappointed) and possible actions (I tell the teacher, I ask for time, I suggest an exchange, We make a rule together). The children match the cards and then form their own sentence: "When I'm angry, I can try to ..."
- **Are we an offended fish?** When have you seen something similar among people? <https://www.facebook.com/thedodosite/videos/223216195029797/>

Annex 3

Evaluation of emotions



Skill Area	Emoji	Note
Recognizing your own feelings		I was scared
Expressing your feelings		
Understanding the feelings of others		
Expressing the feelings of others, interpreting		
Consideration of the feelings of others		
My Messages		
Respectful Speech		
Maintaining control in a conflict situation		
Creativity in the search for solutions		
Willingness to compromise		

Annex 4

Providing Choices

The action section is not new to teachers, but in the ECA program, the opportunity to choose increases, so you have to think through the offer from several angles. Here are some questions that can help you with this:

- Do I understand the individual needs and abilities of the students?
- What differentiated activities do I plan for students with different abilities?
- How do I ensure that all students are actively involved in the actions?
- What methods do I use to support students' independent learning and self-assessment?
- How can I involve parents, experts or other helpers in the action?

- How can I monitor and document the progress of the students during the actions?
- What tools and materials do I prepare for the smooth running of the actions?
- How do I prepare students for collaboration and joint problem-solving?
- How do I ensure that the action contributes to strengthening the intrinsic motivation of the students?
- What strategies do I use to deal with difficulties or conflicts that arise during the actions?

To help, we have also organized exercises into categories.

Annex 5

Action categories with examples

- **Digital skills development: programming, video and filmmaking, photography**
 - To make a video of everything in the garden that moves.
 - "My Day of Learning History" is a slide show from snapshots.
 - Take a series of photos of learning in different ways.
- **Sensory development, psychomotor/coordination exercises, fine motor skills development:**
 - Beading series – pattern making according to colour and shape.
 - Tactile bag (recognition of soft, rough, smooth, granular materials).
 - Pace Walk Statue: they suddenly stiffen into a statue from different tempos.
- **Practicing self-study techniques,**
 - Sketching from a specific text.
 - Write a summary.
 - Copy a drawing.
- **Stress management and relaxation exercises, stress reduction, maintaining emotional balance**
 - Muscle relaxation exercise (tightens-relaxes).
 - To look for words for the increasing and decreasing intensity of an adjective.



- Formulating an I-message.
- **Communication and speech development exercises: vocabulary development, creative writing**
 - Writing a text with your partner: "My grandmother" (with indented titles)
 - Summarize the content of a novel in six words. The others guess the title.
 - Use only your name to play a (drawn) scene.
- **DIY, crafts: Repairs and assembly, recycling projects**
 - Build a shelf in the classroom (if necessary).
 - Let's make a selective waste container.
 - Felt soap.
- **Activities educating environmental awareness: recycling, plant care, forest walks**
 - Make a bird feeder.
 - Germinate beans and observe.

- o Let's learn to compost (what, when, how).
- **Visit external locations**
 - o We can go to a forest to look for the colours of autumn.
 - o We can take part in a museum education session.
 - o We can visit a grandmother who is making compote.
- **Involvement of outsiders and external sites: parents, experts, locals, colleagues, etc.**
 - o We can visit a parent's workplace to get to know the job.

- o A classic factory visit.
- o We can walk in a park and choose a tree to watch for a year.
- **Sustainability**
 - o Observing energy sources in the school: where do they see "green and grey energy".
 - o Packaging comparison: "What produces the least amount of garbage?"
 - o Community garbage collection and making a short "report" with drawings and posters.
- **Projects and theme days**

Annex 6

Sustainability

Successful actions are really effective if they reflect on local needs. Here are three examples of the adaptation and sustainability of actions in the local environment. All three come from the field of environmental competencies (but this is not an expectation!).

- **"The neighbour's garden"** – the creation of a common mini-community garden on an unused area with the involvement of neighbours. From time to time, an "open garden" afternoon can be held, where the children present what they have learned about soil, water, bees, seasonal vegetables, etc.

- **"Sustainable Occupations Day"**: Some locals hold workshops at mini-stations, e.g. repair an object together; Let's get to know composting; Let's try the packaging-free shopping game.

- **Measuring water consumption during "washing"**: A child washes his hands: first with the tap open, then with water poured from a glass. They measure the time with a stopwatch, and the amount of water with a glass. They compare: which method is more "economical".

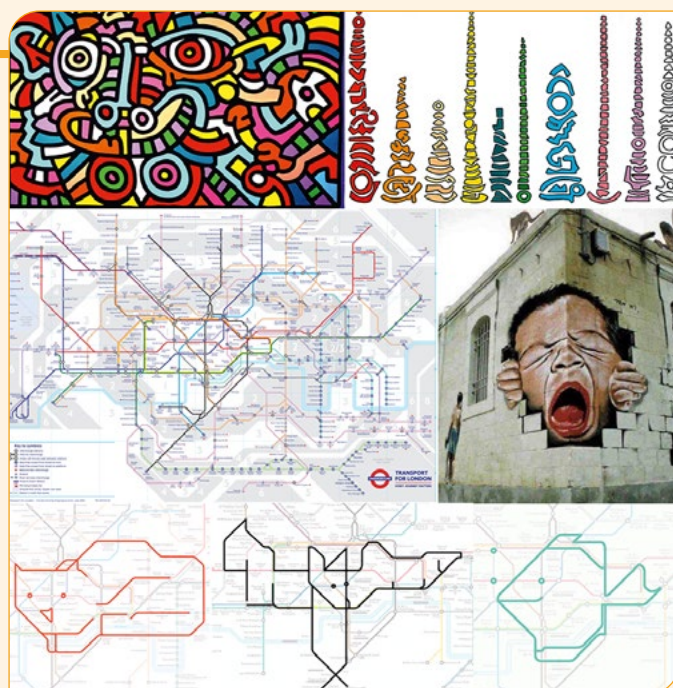
Annex 7

Creativity

To show

It already has a developmental effect if we show artworks that stand out spectacularly from the framework of ordinary thinking. These can also serve as inspiration. For example, let's look at

1. The masterpieces of street art
2. How Ursus Wehrli views a work of art
3. What animals can we find between in the London Underground lines (let's also try the one in Budapest).
4. The interview comes from the internet, where the cognitive side doesn't work, but creativity does. <https://www.ime.usp.br/~vwsetzer/jokes/student-zero-on-exam.htm?utm>





Imitation

These were just a few examples of how to get the mood going. Then comes the imitation tasks:

5. Let's play with the light: let's look for the meaningful shadow.
6. Paint gravel
7. Venn Diagram Ideas



Creative tasks as examples, related to subjects

Mathematics:

- Tessellation exercise: Symmetry, recognizing patterns: arrange hexagonal papers on a sheet of paper without gaps.
- Dice cards: Give at least five different answers to the question: How many sides does the dice have? Solutions can be (2 = outside and inside / 4 = four sides + bottom + top / 6 = four sides and top and bottom / 8 = four outside and four inside and bottom and bottom / 12 = 6 outside and 6 inside / infinity = just need to be split.

Arts and language:

- Visual culture, drama, music: self-expression through "what if...?"-type imaginary exercises.
- Native language/literature: creative writing, storytelling, exchange of perspectives, ending-rewriting.
- Visual: Tangram



Science and mathematics:

- Problem-solving projects, designing experiments, looking for multiple explanations for phenomena.

- Open-ended tasks, searching for multiple solutions, patterns, logical problems.
- <http://littlealchemy.com>

Sustainability:

- Creative ideas and projects for new uses of waste.
- Getting to know alternative energy sources, ideas aimed at reducing energy consumption.
- Saving water, reducing pollutants, improving air quality.
- Learning about healthy, sustainable habits, e.g. local food, selective waste collection.
- Tales, legends, myths
- "What if...?" scenarios, elaboration of alternative decisions, simulations, role-playing.
- Ethics: community projects, creative solutions to local problems.

Project- and theme-based units:

- Cross-curricular projects (e.g. "My City", "Nature and Man", "School of the Future"),
- A product of our own design, an exhibition, a performance.
- Research and design projects: problem identification, brainstorming, prototyping.

Everyday "creative thinking" module:

- Separate creative thinking / "thinking skills" block: idea generation, change of perspective.
- Creativity as an evaluation criterion in all subjects.
- Lateral tasks

Edward de Bono: The creative mind: 54. game – triangle

1. Choose five random words!
2. Select three of these, they are the triangle. Don't use the other two!
3. The three selected words each stand at a tip of the triangle, and they have to relate to the other two.
4. Reason for this connection!

Six random words: compost, cabbage, end, bed-sheet, dragon

Three selected words: compost, cabbage, dragon

Connections:

... cabbage grows big, if the soil has enough compost

... there are belief-systems, where only the boys are brought by the stark, girls bor non cabbage fields – these girls are taken by dragons at a young age

... if dragons eat ember, it's not likely that their „compost“ will be good for the soil

Measuring creativity

Creativity – like everything else – can be measured, but perhaps we can get more valuable information if we promote self-reflection with questions, similar to the processing of the Torrance creativity test.

- What was your relationship with time during the task?
- How did you feel during it, what feelings and thoughts swirled in you?
- If you haven't thought of many ideas, what do you think, why?
- How do you feel now?
- How elaborate or rough are the images?

(elaboration)

- How original and unusual are the drawings? (originality)
- How many different ideas did you use? (flexibility)
- What conclusion do you draw from your answers to the above questions?

Finally, here are two videos. One is a 30-second thought-provoking session, the other is 13 minutes and is about the areas of creativity development.

<https://www.youtube.com/shorts/Db6nHohxOz0>

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E73xrm-CD8hc>

Annex 8

Developing an ECA Lesson Plan Step-by-Step

This time, we have put together a lesson plan that starts from the cognitive side.

Cognitive side

1. Objective: To develop creativity, information processing and memory through active, reflective activities.
2. Duration: 45 minutes
3. Tools: Interactive whiteboard, coloured papers, cards, notebooks, digital assignments
4. Process:
 - Introduction (5 minutes): A short introduction to the concept and importance of cognitive strategies.
 - Problem-solving activity (15 minutes): Solving complex, multi-step problems in groups. The students formulate their own train of thought, follow up and help each other.
 - Creative brainstorming (10 minutes): Generating new, original solutions to a given topic, with free association. Getting to know the rules of brainstorming.
 - Memory and information processing exercise (10 minutes): Taking notes, making summaries; memory game with the help of cards.
 - Reflective closing (5 minutes): Raise awareness of the learned strategies, short joint discussion, questions, self-assessment.
 - Assessment: Students' self-reflection and group feedback

Emotional side

This lesson plan would be suitable for a traditional lesson, and the way of processing could even be called interactive. The schedule is also adjusted to this. We enhance the 45 minutes into 90 minutes, and instead of the 5-minute tuning, we start with a 30-minute emotional block. Here it is:

- Introductory game for pairs: Recognizing emotions: one points to an emotion, the other recognizes an emotion, then a replacement. The teacher can help the task with randomly distributed emotion cards.
- Plenary Emotional Connection – Sharing a Personal Experience: "Who would tell a joyful / scary / frightening story from their life?"
- In individual or small group form, everyone briefly tells a story about a learning situation where they experienced a strong emotion (positive or negative). Discussion about how this emotion affected learning (motivation, attention, perseverance). This can be translated into a joint conversation about the relationship between emotion and learning, or to action (e.g. stress can make it difficult to concentrate, motivation increases endurance). The teacher can stimulate the conversation with helpful questions and aspects.

Action side

According to the Gardner system, we offer activities that focus on different types of intelligence. This ensures that each student can choose a task according to their own strengths..

- Physical-kinesthetic: Role-play – a conflict between two students during a school assignment. Listing emotions.
- Musical: Creating rhythmic parts and melodies. Which one reflects which emotion?
- Interpersonal: Debate based on divisive statements. For example, which is the better companion, the dog or the cat.
- Intrapersonal: Answering self-reflective questions about learning processes.
- Logical-mathematical: Problem-solving tasks in emotional questions.
- Linguistic: Creative writing about the lessons learned in class. E.g.: “When they shout at me”
- Visual-spatial: Imagine and draw a forest where all the trees can speak.
- Natural Sciences: Collecting and analysing data on a natural topic. Such a topic could be: “Today’s weather”. Collect data. How does the weather affect you that day?

Of course, we can also process the same content in several ways, taking into account Gardner’s areas of intelligence. Take, for example, a science topic: The Life of a Tree.

1. Physical-kinesthetic intelligence: Children play out the life of a tree with movements: seed, germ, growth, storm, falling leaves. They experience change and adaptation through their bodies.
2. Natural intelligence: They observe a specific tree: its leaves, its bark, its environment, its inhabitants. They ask questions about how he lives with other living beings.
3. Logical-mathematical intelligence: They estimate the age of the tree, calculate annual rings on a section, compare the size, shade and water requirements of different trees.
4. Verbal-linguistic intelligence: They write a story or a short text “from the tree’s point of view”: what they see, what they experience,

what they are afraid of, what they are happy about.

5. Spatial-visual intelligence: They draw the visible and “invisible” parts of the tree (root system, underground world) or make a map of the tree’s environment.
6. Musical intelligence: They use sounds and rhythms to represent the life of the tree: the wind between the leaves, rain, birds, the change of seasons.
7. Interpersonal (social) intelligence: In a small group, they discuss what the tree “needs” for life and draw parallels with the functioning of the community.
8. Intrapersonal intelligence: Individual reflection: “When do I feel as stable as a tree?” or “What helps me grow?”
9. Practical intelligence: Planting trees, composting, mulching or creating a care plan for a tree.
10. Existential intelligence: A conversation about what time means in the life of a tree, what is left behind, what finally exists, and how humans relate to the living world.

ECA content by subject

We give you another summary. We show that with a little routine, we can easily assign ECA content to each subject:

Hungarian Language and Literature

- Cognitive content: Characterization of characters in fairy tales or poems
- Emotional question: How would you feel if you were in the protagonist’s situation?
- Activity: Role-playing a scene from a text

Mathematics

- Cognitive content: The use of addition and subtraction.
- Emotional question: How does it feel when you solve a difficult task?
- Activity: A treasure hunt game with measurements and additions.

Foreign Language (4th grade)

- Cognitive content: Understanding and using simple sentences.
- Emotional question: Are you embarrassed when you have to speak in a foreign language?
- Activity: Introductory conversation in pairs.

Environmental Awareness

- Cognitive content: Animals that live around us.
- Emotional question: What kind of animal do you have, what do you like about it and why?
- Activity: Draw your existing or desired animal.

Singing and music

- Cognitive content: Recognizing rhythm and melody.
- Emotional question: How do you feel when you manage to find a good melody?
- Activity: Using simple rhythm instruments.

Visual culture

- Cognitive content: Recognition of colours and shapes.
- Emotional question: Can you easily express a feeling when you see a drawing?
- Activity: Create a colourful collage.

Ethics

- Cognitive content: Understanding moral dilemmas.
- Emotional question: What is an example when you had to choose between two good things?
- Activity: Situational exercises and reflections.

Technology and design

- Cognitive content: Understanding simple structures.
- Emotional question: When do you feel pride?
- Activity: Construction and launching of a paper boat.

Digital Culture

- Cognitive Content: Basic Digital Operations.
- Emotional question: How curious are you about working with a computer?
- Activity: Using a simple drawing program.

Annex 9

Introduction Guide

Period	Focus	3 concrete steps
1.	Emotion – introduction of routines	1. Short, 5-10 minutes day starters with emojis 2. Simple conflict management games 3. Keep a short teacher journal
2.	Introduction of ECA lesson plans	1. 1-2 ECA lessons per week with familiar topics 2. Give children a choice 3. Rate with a scale at the end of the lesson
3.	Deepening differentiation	1. Know your children's learning styles 2. Offer 2-3 choices for the first time in the Action section 2. Introduce mini learning contracts with 3-5 children
4.	Full integration	1. 4-5 ECA hours every week 2. Share your experience with 2 new colleagues 3. Answer 5 self-reflective questions every week

We can also grasp the difficulty of the task.

Period length	Difficulty	3 concrete steps
1-2 weeks	Easy routines	1. 5-minute check-in round: Shares 2. A two-minute exercise break every hour (jumping, stretching) 3. Use open-ended questions
2-4 weeks	Medium challenge	1. Group work of three or four people in changing groups 2. Ten-minute six-hat mini task 3. Introduction of the restorative circle (What happened? – What to do?)
1-3 months	More difficult steps	1. ECA Lesson Design 2. Flexible integration of the curriculum 3. Diary round (from the upper levels of the Dilts model)

Annex 10

Individual and differentiated learning management tips

- Recognizing and taking into account the different physical, emotional and mental needs of students in the design of the learning environment, by raising awareness of motivational factors.
- Identification of individual learning styles and differentiation of tasks, tools and forms of assessment adapted to them.
- Flexible learning paths and forms of learning by providing task choices.
- Assign specific roles, with regular role swapping exercises, so that everyone can try themselves in different roles.
- Using visual and digital tools (timer, wall calendar, shared notes, online collaboration) to support time management, organization, and collaboration.
- Developing a common set of rules, which the students themselves formulate, and leading regular feedback rounds after group work.
- Organizing training-like sessions where children can practice their non-violent conflict management, communication and cooperation skills in safe situations.
- Developing self-reflection with question patterns (eg. "What went well?", "What would you do differently?") and supporting journaling or short notes.
- Building a supportive, empathetic teacher-student relationship: patience for differences, openness to student feedback, authentic communication.
- To develop stable routines, subroutines and transparent classroom structures, using a variety of methods and teaching aids, with reflective teacher behaviour.
- Cooperation with parents and professionals to support students by sharing experiences in two ways.

Annex 11

Sense of achievement

- Assessment of skills and interests
- Set your own goals
- Small steps
- Differentiated tasks, attention to different areas of intelligence, especially movement
- Instead of homework, relevant tasks that can be done at home
- Choice
- Positive reinforcement for the process and not only for the result
- Provide the opportunity to share experiences
- Supportive and honest feedback
- Support self-reflection and self-assessment so that students become aware of their own development
- Projects, thematic days
- Games and experiential learning forms, competitions, challenges,
- Safe, interesting physical learning environment, alternatives to desks
- Interactive presentations: questions, illustration, followability, periodic summaries, systems thinking

Annex 12

Integrating self-study and group work

- Clarifying learning goals: Setting clear, unambiguous, individual goals for students.
- Development of conflict management and co-operation skills: Parallel teaching and training on communication and consensus-building.
- Use a variety of learning tools: Digital tools, presentations, poster making, or oral presentations that support both individual and group work.
- Providing continuous feedback: The teacher and group members regularly give each other feedback on the work, strengthening self-reflection and development.
- Assigning student roles: Assigning clear roles within the group (e.g. coordinator, notary, time manager) that help organized work and individual responsibility, and give everyone a task.
- Independent research and information gathering: Students prepare the material individually or in pairs, working at their own pace and in their own way.
- Group discussion and problem-solving: Sharing independently collected information among group members, forming opinions and making decisions together.
- Time management and scheduling: The teacher helps students manage their time effectively by ensuring that they have enough time for activities.
- Harmonization of assessment criteria: Students should know that both individual and group performance matter, this motivates them to participate responsibly.

Annex 13

Scaling

Scaling is one of the best tools for developing students' self-assessment as well as diagnosing knowledge and skills. Let's see three scales with different focuses: one on the emotional side, one on the cognitive side, and one on the action side.

Conflict scale

1. In constant conflict with his environment: He often shouts, provokes, has difficulty controlling his temper, conflicts are constant, and conflicts usually end in an aggressive, sometimes submissive way.

2. Periodically loud: He still shouts many times, but he already has minor successes in managing conflicts, sometimes he manages to avoid a confrontation or resolves conflict with mutual acceptance.
3. He is more and more reserved: He shouts less, manages to resolve conflict situations constructively more often, and can sometimes be insightful.
4. He is becoming more balanced: He loses control less often, is able to regulate emotions, and resolved conflicts are the majority.
5. Conscious problem management: Handles disagreements more and more effectively, often sees his own mistakes, and can be self-reflective.
6. Problem solver and mediator: Can also show self-control and empathy, and as a mediator helps to resolve disputes peacefully.

Történelem skála-forrásfeldolgozás

1. Basic disinterest: Submits the paper blank, does not deal with the sources.
2. Text recognition: Reads through the source, but does not understand or use its content.
3. Limited use: Copies snippets from the source, but no critical approach.
4. Simple analysis: You can find the basic information, but there is little deeper connection.
5. Critical processing: Takes into account several aspects, recognizes the limitations and value of the source, consciously compares different information.
6. Complex source processing: Validates all relevant aspects, compares and analyses sources, and draws independent historical conclusions in a well-founded manner.

Action: Bird Feeder Making Scale

1. Not started the activity: Not showing interest or refusing to participate in the task.
2. Passive participation: Tries to do the activity, but makes little effort, does not progress without help. He works without interest / out of compulsion.
3. Basic execution: Performs the simpler parts of the activity, but needs strong guidance and support.
4. Independent work: Is able to perform the essential parts of the activity independently and with appropriate quality.
5. Complex implementation: Performs the activity efficiently, integrating several sub-processes, and is able to solve problems in the meantime.
6. Creative and independent development: Enriches the activity with his/her own ideas and innovative solutions, and demonstrates a high level of professional or practical knowledge.

Annex 14

The self-assessment routine

This can be gradually developed in young children along the following steps:

1. Use simple, visual tools: Images, symbols, emojis, pictograms to express emotions and performance in a simple way. Figure them out together.
2. Short, daily exercises and routines: For example, at the end of class or after an activity, ask the children to indicate how much fun they had or how successful the task was. A simple form: use their arms to indicate satisfaction, success, etc. – if they hold them up, it means 10, if they lower them it means 0.
3. Positive reinforcement and encouragement: After each self-assessment action, reinforce children in a positive way so that self-assessment becomes a positive experience.
4. Shared conversations and sharing: Sit down with the children from time to time and talk about self-assessment together.
5. Gradually introduce self-reflection questions: Start with simple questions like “What was your favourite part?” and move on to more complex ones.
6. Track your progress: Work together to create small booklets or drawings where you can show your progress over time, reinforcing the habit of self-reflection.

Annex 15

Teacher Development Assessment

Its effectiveness may be affected by the following factors:

- Goal-orientation: Evaluation is carried out along clear, well-defined objectives
- Consider individual skills or pace: Avoid using only external standards.
- Quality of feedback: Concrete, constructive and developmental, multi-criteria
- Use diverse assessment tools
- Documentation and monitoring: this helps to raise awareness
- Engage students
- Supportive learning environment: An atmosphere where mistakes are accepted and students can feel free to try
- Regularity and continuous application: assessment is an integral part of the learning process
- Developing the teacher's own self-knowledge

Annex 16

Assessment criteria

Here is the collection of aspects:

- The evaluation criteria should be the result of the joint work of the student(s) and the teacher.
- Objectives should be clear and measurable, and everyone involved knows what the expected results are.
- Different levels are created. The wording of these should always be inspiring.
- As many aspects as possible should appear in the evaluation. If we say that there is no acceptable source processing, it says much less than if we break down the criteria into small units: the level and number of sources used, formal elements, content, linguistic quality, argumentation.
- Assign multiple levels to each criterion to make the result comparable.
- Relevance and consistency: Make sure that the criteria are consistent with the learning objectives and relevant to the task.
- Simplicity and clarity: Criteria should be clearly formulated and should not be complicated or ambiguous.
- In the light of experience, we think about whether something needs to be changed together with the students.

Annex 17

Receiving the student's self-assessment

We can think according to several aspects:

- Relevance: Does self-assessment focus on learning goals and critical aspects of the task?
- Depth of self-reflection: Does the student recognize his or her strengths and areas for improvement?
- Consistency: Is self-assessment consistent with previous feedback and performance? If not, can the student justify the differences?
- Objectivity and genuineness: Doesn't self-assessment distort excessively positively or negatively? Do external factors affect self-assessment?
- Compliance with assessment criteria: Does the content of the self-assessment cover the pre-defined assessment criteria? Does it point out important learning aspects?
- Can self-assessment be a starting point for further development paths?
- Does self-assessment reflect the student's intention to develop?

Annex 18

Establishment of routines and subroutines

- Arrival attunement: At the beginning of the day, a short, structured, but free-to-enter start of the day (circle, movement, silence, chosen activity) indicates that each child can arrive with their own current status. For this, the Cat card deck developed by the Rogers Foundation can be used, which expresses emotions. <https://rogersalapitvany.hu/termek/2437/>
- Status indication: Children can indicate how they are in a simple way (colour, gesture, a word, a card) without having to explain.
- Inclusion of choice points: Throughout the day, a real choice (task, tool, pace, role) appears regularly.
- Short, common framing: The teacher tells what will happen, why it is important, and where there is room for manoeuvre – this creates security and transparency. The larger the space you can choose, the better.
- Action-based learning: Learning takes place in movement, creation, and experimentation, not only in verbal or frontal form.
- Flexible time management: The teacher monitors the rhythm of the group and slows down, stops



or switches if necessary, not rigidly sticking to the preliminary plan. He sees that someone can't find their place, asks about it, inquires about it, and if they are given authorization, they help.

- Observation instead of evaluation: Throughout the day, observation and reflection are more emphasized than rating or correction.
- Treating conflicts as learning situations: Conflicts that arise are not distractions, but (joint) learning situations that can be processed.
- Closing and looking back: At the end of the day, a short reflection: what was easy, what was difficult, what felt good, what worked out, what should be changed?
- Predictable, human presence: The consistent, authentic, emotionally available presence of the teacher accompanies the whole day.

Annex 19

Motivation

The following list consists of the elements of a complex system. This system is person-centeredness itself, which provides the background of the ECA approach. We don't claim to have listed all the components of the system, but the list is still quite long.

- Taking into account individual development rate
- Active involvement of learners in the learning process, facilitator role
- Creative, experiential activities
- Differentiated approach
- Support for community activities
- Creating an atmosphere of trust through the teacher's attitude
- Encouraging independence and responsibility through conscious pedagogical work
- Appreciation of students' personal experiences
- Positive teaching attitude and supportive presence
- Recognition of learners' uniqueness
- Moving and creative actions
- Creating an environment where mistakes can be made
- Creative and practical activities are a pleasure
- Building on student interest
- Noticing and recognition of your successes and efforts

Annex 20

Change Management

What else can the teacher do with those who have a harder time tolerating the changes, e.g. autistic children?

- Always announce the change in advance, tell them why it is good or necessary. Give them time.
- If you can, start with small changes before implementing a bigger one.
- Frame the new things positively: "This will be different from the usual..."
- Avoid the word "must." Convince yourself that the given change is a good thing
- Confirm success. "Thank you for adapting so cleverly!"
- Inform parents about the change.

Below are two tasks that help to develop the flexibility of the class community and to process changes emotionally.

- "Routine change chain" – modifying daily habits: Choose a routine (e.g. greeting "We say hello twice today") and pass it on in a chain: the first child comes up with a small change, the next one passes it on. At the end, they evaluate: "What was strange?" "Why was this good?"
- "Superhero Change Mission": Read a fairy tale where the protagonist/situation changes. Kids make a "superhero card": "What's your superpower for change?" (e.g. "I ask questions", "I help someone else"). They practice it in a role-playing game: "If you have a new benchmate, what will your superhero do?"

Annex 21

Teacher's Self-Reflection

Another list, this time less of a checklist and more of a thought-provoking one:

- Developing awareness: Continuously examine your own teaching style, decisions and pedagogical practice from the point of view of effectiveness.
- Identify and analyse problems: Feel free to look at the situations that have caused you difficulties and look for the reasons behind them.
- Identify positive areas and areas for improvement: Evaluate successful elements as well as those that need improvement. Consciously highlight good practices.
- Observe your emotional reactions and how they affect your work with children.
- Practice feedback and self-criticism: Seek and receive students' feedback, and reflect on it honestly, treating it as an opportunity for improvement.
- Look for feedback from benevolent colleagues, parents, and external professionals. Feel free

to hold demonstration classes for these invitees.

- Find a supervisor partner, feel free to share your dilemmas. You're not alone!
- Use situational analysis, journaling, situational cards, or mentoring to gain a deeper understanding of your own pedagogical functioning.
- See your job as an opportunity for growth, where you can learn something every day.
- You should also set development goals.
- Examine what values you stand for and how they help your work.
- Look for courses and trainings that refresh your skills or make up for those that are still missing.
- Be open to new opportunities and good practices.

The following video shows some self-knowledge tools from the far from finite list.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kik6aieEY-mo&t=5s>

Communication with parents

The following list can help you think about some aspects of maintaining a satisfying relationship:

- Clear, public channels of communication must be maintained (letters, parents' forums, information evenings), but their framework must be strictly regulated.
- Common school principles and rules that are accepted by both teachers and parents – including confidentiality and conflict intervention procedures.
- Trust-building, but firm and consistent feedback to parents to see that the school really represents the child's interests, but always keep secrets and confidential information.
- Make it clear what and how you want to share with parents as partners, and what the teacher decides on a professional basis alone.

At the first-grade parents' meeting, it is worth asking the following four things from the parents in

order to ensure good communication later on. Ask parents to:

1. Be open to continuous dialogue and cooperation with the teacher. Work out together what this means exactly.
2. Share with the teacher the child's personal needs, habits and possible difficulties so that the teacher can provide personalized support.
3. Participate in school programs and parent meetings to be up-to-date and shape the course of the school year together. Develop a reminder system that can help parents. Find communication channels and think through their communication rules together.
4. Try to maintain trust even in the face of problems in order to achieve common goals. Emphasize that they should respect pedagogical confidentiality and provide their child with the necessary support at home. In the light of experience, return to this question regularly in the coming months.

6.

Short lesson plans from practice

This chapter is included in the manual to make the operation of ECA visible. The lesson plans below are not „ready-made recipes“, but visual patterns that can be customized. Their goal is not to be transferable without changes, but to show how a learning situation is organized along the ECA

logic. All sketches follow the same structure: an intertwined system of emotional attunement, collective thinking and active action. The examples come from different subject areas to make it clear that ECA is not a subject-specific method, but an approach.

Example 1

The Earth (LP1)

ECA Interpretation

- **E – Emotion:** The theme of the Earth is related to personal experiences (hiking, residence, nature), so it creates involvement and emotional security in a natural way.
- **C – Cognition:** Through observation and comparison, children form their own categories while forming basic concepts about the planet and its environment.
- **A – Action:** The creation (model, drawing, common surface) provides an opportunity for active participation, acceptance of different tempos and solutions.

Teacher focus: The emphasis is not on the “correct” representation, but on the representation of the thought process.



Example 2

Volcanoes (LP 3)

ECA Interpretation

- **E – Emotion:** The theme of volcanoes evokes strong emotional reactions (excitement, fear, curiosity) that can be consciously involved in the learning process.
- **C – Cognition:** During the observation and discussion of the phenomena, children look for cause-and-effect relationships and formulate their own questions.

- **A – Action:** Modelling and experimentation deepen understanding through action and give room for individual experimentation.

Teacher's focus: Keeping and interpreting emotional reactions is at least as important as the science content. The analogy of a volcano can be used to understand anger and rage.



Example 3

The Human Body (LP 3)

ECA Interpretation

- **E – Emotion:** The theme of the body offers a direct connection to self-knowledge.
- **C – Cognition:** Children rely on their own body experiences to interpret basic bodily functions and connections.

- **A – Action:** The large-scale, joint creation and movement elements provide an opportunity for active participation and cooperation.

Teacher focus: The assignment promotes self-reflection, not memorization of details.



The materials presented here do not only serve the transfer of knowledge, but also reflect the approach of application in pedagogical practice. The images and templates provide an opportunity for teachers to try out the methods presented in their own teaching environment and adapt them to the individual needs of the children. During the chapter, it became emphasized that the processing of student experiences, reflective practice and creative problem-solving serve to consolidate knowledge on the one hand. At the same time, they also strengthen

children's independence, motivation and emotional security.

Overall, this chapter is a bridge between pedagogical theory and everyday practice: it provides inspiration for a person-centred approach and shows how templates, visual aids and project management tools can be integrated in a way that each learner's abilities and individual journey can be enforced. The teacher is not only a guide, but also a partner in the learning process, creating an opportunity for the children's creativity, self-confidence and independent thinking to unfold.